evolving to add contemporary touches to their interiors. Think elegant show kitchens framed by lush foliage and beaten brass bells, modern furniture and professional service.

### PARSI DAIRY FARM

- **Then:** Opened at Princess Street in 1916 by Nariman Ardeshir, the dairy soon produced milk-based products that captured Mumbai's heart.
- **Now:** Four fourth-generation siblings—Bakhtyar Irani, Sarfaraz Irani, Zeenia Patel and Parvana Mistry—run the show. A readily recognisable red door leads into the flagship store at Marine Lines and new locations in Ghatkopar and Borivali. Products and packaging display old-world charm and flavours even as they're as contemporary as they come in terms of quality control and recyclability.

### GALLOPS

- **Then:** Gallops, a Continental and Indian restaurant run by Rahul Malik and Jasmine Singh at the Royal Western India Turf Club, has been a rare gem for those in the know since it opened in 1986.
- **Now:** A restaurant that has stayed the course and updated to keep pace with the times, they have added an elegant al fresco section with cabanas and gorgeous fairy lighting, special-occasion menus and a pivot towards private parties/ events. A refresh of the main restaurant is coming up. ■

**–Priya Pathiyan**







**GLAM EATS**
Clockwise from left: Indian Accent in Delhi; its lobster-toast-pickles dish; a dish of Ambemohar rice, morel, yakhni, quail, eggs, etc from Masque and the restaurant in Mumbai



RESTAURANTS

# A Taste of India

Delhi's **INDIAN ACCENT** and Mumbai's **MASQUE** make it to the extended list of the World's 50 Best Restaurants 2024

Indian cuisine is having a moment on the world stage. Once dismissed for being too spicy and rich, the tide has turned with new-age restaurants like chef Gaggan Anand's Gaggan in Bangkok and Himanshu Saini's Trèsind Studio in Dubai being featured on the list of the World's 50 Best Restaurants 2024. While Gaggan stands at No. 9 and has been crowned the 'Best Restaurant in Asia 2024', Trèsind Studio is at No. 13.

Earlier, Indian Accent (Delhi) and Masque (Mumbai) made it to the extended list (51-100) of the World's 50 Best Restaurants 2024. Their inventive tasting menus with local ingredients earned them spots among the world's most esteemed dining spots.

While Rohit Khattar-owned Indian Accent made a re-entry at No.89, Masque helmed by self-taught cook and entrepreneur Aditi Dugar and chef Varun Totlani debuted at No. 78.

Dubbed "India's most forward-thinking restaurant" by the World's 50 Best jury, Masque, set within a former Mumbai textile mill, offers a 10-course tasting menu that spotlights the wealth of local produce. For instance, their new menu has a chaat with textures of strawberry (smoked, fresh, dried, pulped) with crispy *ponkh* and a strawberry dressing.

What's the secret to Masque's success? "The restaurant's output is collaborative, which means the entire team has input on what we're doing. Whether it's the food we've grown up eating, different styles of cooking, our personal histories– all of that has a chance to show up on the place, and everyone has something to contribute," says Varun Totlani, head chef at Masque.

Similarly, Indian Accent's reputation for serving classics with a contemporary twist has been retained ever since its inception in 2009. The chef's tasting menu is a smorgasbord of small plates, interspersed with dishes like *meetha achaar* pork spareribs with carambola (star fruit) or sea bass with *gongura* pickle and coconut barley. "To maintain consistency, we have been innovating new dishes, creating new tasting menus, and training the staff," shares Chef Manish Mehrotra, culinary director at Indian Accent New Delhi, New York, and Mumbai. ■

**–Geetika Sachdev**